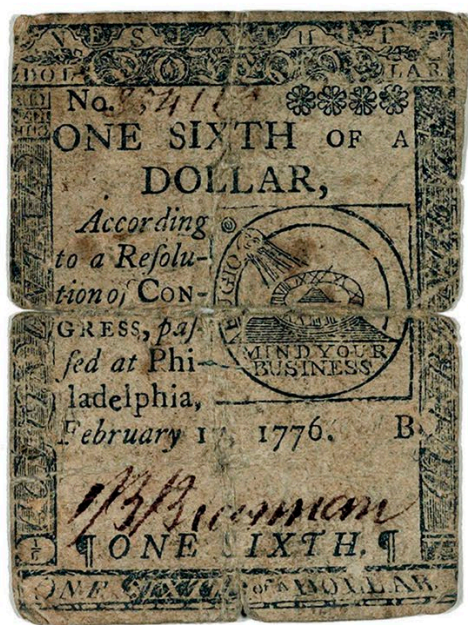


Money

People have been recording the exchange of goods since 30,000 BCE. Gold and silver coins were circulating in 600 BCE, while paper money emerged in China in the 11th century CE. In the modern era, new types of money and innovative methods of payment have been developed, from credit cards to contactless technology.

FAST FACTS

- The largest denomination bill ever printed in the US was the \$100,000 note, in 1934 and 1935.
- Only 8 percent of all the money in the world is actual physical cash—the rest is digital money that exists only on computers.
- The average life of a \$5 or \$10 note in the US is just over four years.



US dollar

- **What?** Dollar
- **Who?** Bank of North America
- **Where and when?** US, 1785

In the period that followed American independence in 1776, the US had no one single currency. In 1785, delegates from the 13 colonies authorized the issue of a new currency called the “dollar.” In 1792, the US Congress confirmed the US dollar as the country’s standard unit of money. The word “dollar” comes from the German *thaler*, which was a silver coin used throughout Europe for almost 400 years.

Traveler’s check

- **What?** American Express traveler’s check
- **Who?** Marcellus Flemming Berry
- **Where and when?** US, 1891

A traveler’s check is a bank-issued paper currency that allows the user to buy goods and services in a foreign country. In 1891, the president of American

Express, Marcellus Flemming Berry, launched the first system of international traveler’s check. Traveler’s checks were popular for a century, but there has been a steady decline in their use due to the widespread adoption of credit cards, ATMs, and online payments.



Traveler’s check for use in Europe, 1990s

Credit card

- **What?** BankAmericard
- **Who?** Bank of America
- **Where and when?** US, 1958



In the US in September 1958, Bank of America sent 60,000 Fresno residents what it called the BankAmericard. This marked the launch of the world’s first successful credit card. In 1966, a rival group of banks launched MasterCard, which would later become MasterCard. In that same year, the Barclaycard was launched in the UK as the first credit card outside the US.

Modern credit card